Can Exposure to Celebrities Reduce Prejudice? The Effect of Mohamed Salah on Islamophobic Behaviors and Attitudes – CORRIGENDUM

Ala' Alrababa'h, William Marble, Salma Mousa, and Alexandra A. Siegel

doi:10.1017/S0003055421000423. Published online by Cambridge University Press, 7 June 2021.
American Political Science Review 115(4): 1111–1128.

We regret an error in Figure 1 of the article: "Can Exposure to Celebrities Reduce Prejudice? The Effect of Mohamed Salah on Islamophobic Behaviors and Attitudes" (Alrababa'h et al. 2021a).

Figure 1 displays the share of respondents to surveys by YouGov-Cambridge who agreed that there is a fundamental clash between Islam and British values. We include data for 20 waves between January 2015 and June 2018. In the published version, we mistakenly assigned the survey dates to the 20 waves in reverse order. This occurred when we converted an SPSS file we received from YouGov to a CSV file that we used for the data analysis. Since the dates are incorrect, the published figure shows an incorrect trend and the paragraph that describes it is also incorrect.

In this correction, we deposit the original data file we received from YouGov along with corrected code, which reads the survey dates directly from that file. These corrected files in version 2 of the replication archive for this article, available on the *APSR* Dataverse (Alrababa'h et al. 2021b). The corrected figure and updated caption are below:

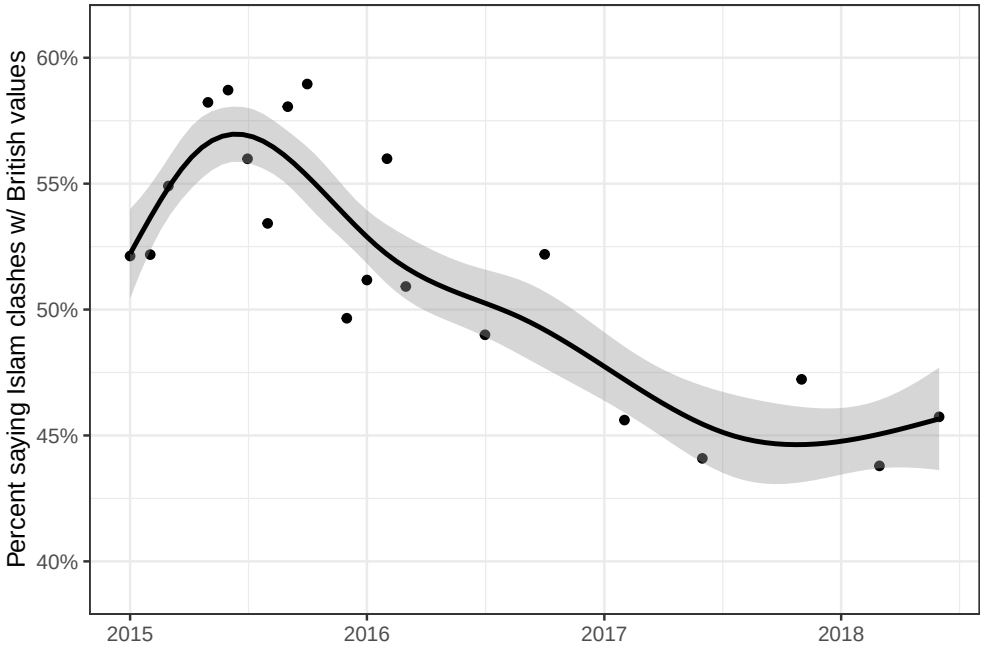


Figure 1: Attitudes toward Islam in the British Public between 2015 and 2018. *Note*: Source: The YouGov-Cambridge Center. The vertical axis is the percentage of survey respondents stating that "there is a fundamental clash between Islam and the values of British society." Points are weighted averages within survey waves; the trend line is a GAM fit to 34,309 survey responses using survey weights.

The paragraph describing Figure 1 on Page 1114 should also be corrected to read as follows:

> Public opinion data also reflect negative attitudes toward Islam. Figure 1 summarizes polling data from YouGov on the belief that "there is a fundamental clash between Islam and the values of British society." In 2015, over half of respondents agreed with this statement. This share declined in 2016 and 2017, although about 45% of respondents continued to affirm this view in 2018.

We also compared the data we received from YouGov with the data published on its website (Rogers de Waal 2016; Yougov 2017, 2018). The share of respondents who agreed that there is a fundamental clash matches the data summaries available online but there is a small difference in sample sizes. The file we received contains 50 more respondents than the data available online for the waves in February 2017 (2,102 in our file vs. 2,052 on the website) and June 2018 (1,688 in our file vs. 1,638 on the website). This difference is attributable to the inclusion of respondents living in Northern Ireland in the file we received, compared to the summary of "GB adults" published on the YouGov website. After dropping these respondents, we reproduce the unweighted sample sizes within demographic groups exactly. Given that the figure is meant to capture public opinion in Great Britain, and the other waves include no respondents from Northern Ireland, we have dropped these respondents in our corrected figure. The number of survey responses in the corrected caption above reflects this change. Finally, in the caption for Figure 1, we changed "respondents" to "responses" because some YouGov panelists took part in more than one wave: the 34,309 responses come from 28,990 unique respondents.

References

Alrababa'h, Ala', William Marble, Salma Mousa, and Alexandra A. Siegel. 2021a. "Can Exposure to Celebrities Reduce Prejudice? The Effect of Mohamed Salah on Islamophobic Behaviors and Attitudes." *American Political Science Review* 115(4): 1111–1128. doi:10.1017/S0003055421000423.

Alrababa'h, Ala', William Marble, Salma Mousa, and Alexandra A. Siegel. 2021b. "Replication Data for: Can Exposure to Celebrities Reduce Prejudice? The Effect of Mohamed Salah on Islamophobic Behaviors and Attitudes." https://doi.org/10.7910/DVN/2JKWNS. Harvard Dataverse, version 2.

Rogers de Waal, Joel. 2016. "GB Tracker: Islam and British Values." YouGov, February 19. Accessed September 17, 2026. https://yougov.com/en-gb/articles/14621-tracker-islam-and-british-values.

YouGov. 2017. "YouGov / University of Cambridge Survey Results: Fieldwork 12th–13th February 2017." http://d25d2506sfb94s.cloudfront.net/cumulus_uploads/document/9u1mmsq0we/YGC%20Tracker%20GB%20Feb%2017.pdf.

YouGov. 2018. "YouGov/Cambridge Survey Results: Fieldwork 20th–21st June 2018." https://d25d2506sfb94s.cloudfront.net/cumulus_uploads/document/u330wrqt0i/YGC_Tracker_GB_Jun_18.pdf.